dead in the middle of the effort. We had the Australian phone lines down pat, and no one could reach us. Until 1 October 1991 that was. After that date the Feds managed to trace a line back from Nortel and started tapping Prime Suspect's phone. He led them to Trax, and then to me. The Feds were listening to us, hearing our conversations, watching our moves. They called it Operation Weather. It dawned on us that we were on borrowed time. Trax flipped and went to the police. The police came and dragged Prime Suspect away from a party on 29 October. The game was up. Or, more accurately, the game, for me, was really beginning.

I was alone and sad when they came. My wife and child had just left, and I had come to the end of my rope. My computer disks were strewn around the computer table. The squat was a mess, and I sat on the sofa reading – a vision of things to come – the prison letters of George Jackson, kept in the toughest US prisons at the pleasure of the authorities. I was broken. I was listening, half listening, to a telephone fault signal that was sounding through my stereo speakers. At 11.30 that night there was a knock at the door and a play of shadows outside. The police announced themselves and I thought of all the times I had expected them, all the times I dreamt they were coming. I opened the door and found about a dozen federal officers with battering equipment. A man at the front looked me in the eye as if he always knew we would meet. At that moment it occurred to me that the disks with the Pentagon stuff on them weren't in the beehive. They were on my desk in full view of the cops. 'I'm Ken Day,' the head policeman said. 'I believe you've been expecting me.'